

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Supreme Lamp, King of Knowledge Mantras

Ārya-agrapradīpa-dhāraṇī-vidyārāja · Toh 858 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྟེན་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱུ་པ་སྒྲོམ་མཆོག་གི་གྲུས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Supreme Lamp, King of Knowledge Mantras (Sanskrit: Ārya Agrapradīpadhāraṇī Vidyārāja; Tibetan: Phags pa rig sngags kyi rgyal po sgron ma mchog gi gzungs) is a dhāraṇī text, a scripture centered on a protective formula of spoken power. It is set in Śrāvastī, at the Jeta Grove, where the Buddha is teaching a vast assembly of monks, gods, humans, and bodhisattvas. His discourse turns to a distant world-realm called Boundless Flowers, where a buddha named Supreme Lamp dwells, and the dhāraṇī takes its name and authority from this buddha. In the canon it is Toh 858 in the Kangyur, belonging to the Tantra division, in the class of dhāraṇī and related ritual scriptures.

In the Indian language: Ārya Agrapradīpadhāraṇī Vidyārāja. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Supreme Lamp, King of Knowledge Mantras.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great assembly of the Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks, with many hundreds of thousands of gods and humans, and with many hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas. Surrounded on all sides, and looking out before him, he was teaching the Dharma.

Beyond a hundred thousand million buddha-fields from this buddha-field, there is a world-realm called Boundless Flowers. There the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha named Supreme Lamp dwells, lives, and sustains himself, and also teaches the Dharma. He sent two bodhisattvas, named Great Light and Boundless Light, to this world-realm, the Sahā world (Endurance).

Then those two bodhisattvas went to the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, where the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha Śākyamuni was, and having arrived there, they bowed with their heads at the feet of the Blessed One. They circumambulated the Blessed One three times and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the two bodhisattvas spoke to the Blessed One as follows.

Blessed One, beyond ten million hundred thousand buddha-fields there is a world-realm called Boundless Flowers. There the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha named Supreme Lamp now dwells, lives, and sustains himself, and teaches the Dharma. That Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha Supreme Lamp, has sent us two to this world-realm, the Sahā world. He asks after the Blessed One: Is the Blessed One free from harm? Is he free from affliction? Is he light and agile in body? Does he live in comfort? Does he abide in strength and ease, in contact with what is without fault and blemish?

He also spoke thus: Here, is there anyone at all, whether human or non-human, whether a spirit, a flesh-eater, a yakṣa, a rākṣasa, a kumbhāṇḍa, a leader of kumbhāṇḍas, a king, a great minister, a thief, a snake, a worm, a corpse-worm, a bee, or a scorpion, or any near affliction whatever, who is causing harm?

For the sake of the welfare of sentient beings, for their healing, their happiness, so that they may possess radiance, splendor, renown, good qualities, strength, and good complexion, and for their protection, concealment, and safekeeping, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly awakened buddha Supreme Lamp has also sent these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. They are as follows:

Jvale jvale, jvale gate, hukku, mukku, saṃmate, mahāsaṃmate, mahājvale, jvabalame, sahe sahe, mahājvale, ukke mukke, śame, saṃmate, mahāsaṃmate, mahāśame svāhā.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. Receive them, recite them, master them, and understand them fully. And teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearance of a buddha is hard to find. These root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra are hard to find. Ānanda, even one who holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is extremely hard to find.

Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, receives, retains, and recites these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, understands them fully, and teaches them extensively to others, will remember their lives for seven lifetimes. And in this very life, apart from the effects of past karma, they will be thoroughly delivered from all harm caused by others, and they will be in harmony with all beings. Ānanda, these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra were taught by seventy-seven million buddhas. Whoever is delivered by these

root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is gathered into the company of all of them."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Invincible rose from his seat. Arranging his upper robe over one shoulder and setting his right knee on the ground, he bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and spoke to the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I too, for the sake of sentient beings, for their healing, their happiness, so that they may possess radiance, splendor, renown, good qualities, strength, and good complexion, and for their protection, concealment, and safekeeping, will recite these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. They are as follows:

Atte, batte, natte, kunatte, pukase, kupukase, kase, anakase, nāmakase, anuta, prānuta, khaje, mahākhaje, sadapphe, tadapphe, tudapphe, hili mili, tile svāhā."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. Receive them, recite them, master them, and understand them fully. And teach them extensively and correctly to others as well. Ānanda, the appearance of a buddha is hard to find. These root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra are hard to find. Ānanda, even one who holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is extremely hard to find.

Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, receives, retains, and recites these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, understands them fully, and teaches them extensively to others, will remember their lives for twelve lifetimes. And in this very life, apart from the effects of past karma, they will be thoroughly delivered from all harm caused by others, and they will be in harmony with all beings. Ānanda, these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra were taught by eighty-two million buddhas. Whoever is delivered by these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is gathered into the company of all of them."

Then Mañjuśrī, who had become a youth, rose from his seat. Arranging his upper robe over one shoulder and setting his right knee on the ground, he bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and spoke to the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I too, for the sake of sentient beings, for their healing, their happiness, so that they may possess radiance, splendor, renown,

and virtue, so that they may possess strength, and so that they may possess a good complexion, and for their protection, concealment, and safeguarding, I too shall recite these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. They are these:

Akṣe, pakṣe, najite, nāgasare, nahile, jahile, jahilavate, caṇḍilavate svāhā.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, grasp these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. Take them up, hold them, master them, and fully realize them. And teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearing of a buddha is hard to find. These root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra are hard to find. Ānanda, one who holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is also exceedingly hard to find.

"Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, receives, upholds, recites, and fully realizes these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, and teaches them extensively to others, will remember their lives for thirteen lifetimes. Even in this very life, apart from the ripening of past karma, they will be thoroughly delivered from every harm that comes from others, and will be in harmony with all beings. Ānanda, these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra were taught by eight hundred and twenty million buddhas. Whoever is delivered by these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is gathered into the company of all of them."

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, I too, for the sake, benefit, and happiness of sentient beings, so that they may possess radiance, splendor, renown, virtue, strength, and a good complexion, and for their protection, concealment, and safeguarding, declare these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. They are these:

Aṭṭe, baṭṭe, naṭṭe, kunaṭṭe, ṭake, eḍake, tatābe, tuṭābe, raṭake, lole, hule, hile, mile, tile, śīle, śīla, aḍhe, baḍhe, naḍhe, kunaḍhe, aḍapatī, baṇavatī, kase kase kase, phase phase phase, mahāphase phase svāhā."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, grasp these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. Take them up, hold them, master them, and fully realize them. And teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearing of a buddha is hard to find. These root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra are hard to find. Ānanda, one who teaches these dhāraṇī mantras is also exceedingly hard to find.

"Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, receives, upholds, recites, and fully realizes these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, and teaches them extensively to others, will remember their lives for fourteen lifetimes. Even in this very life, apart from the ripening of past karma, they will be delivered from every harm that comes from others, and will be in harmony

with all beings. Ānanda, these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra were taught by eight hundred and forty million buddhas. Whoever is delivered by these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is gathered into the company of all of them.

"If any sons or daughters of good family should perform protection, safeguarding, holding, binding, pacification, and the bringing of well-being by means of these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra upon a dry tree that has no moisture in it, then shoots and leaves will grow from that tree, and flowers and fruits will come to be. How much more so, then, for a human being."

Namaḥ sarva buddhebhyaḥ siddhyantu dhāraṇī. Mantra-pada-ni svāhā.

Then the Blessed One spoke once more to the monks. "Monks, for the sake of sentient beings, for their benefit and their happiness; to endow them with radiance, with majesty, with renown, with good qualities, with strength, and with a healthy complexion; and for the sake of protecting, safeguarding, and shielding them, I shall also teach other root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. They are these:

Atte, matte, pake, pārake, pekeḍā, dramati, taramati, ṭḍamaṭi, ṭḍamaṭi, ṭḍaṭure, sure, hile, mule, tile svāhā."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra. Receive them, hold them, and master them. Understand them fully, and teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearance of a buddha is hard to find. These root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra are hard to find. Ānanda, one who holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is also exceedingly hard to find.

"Ānanda, any son or daughter of good family who holds, receives, retains, recites, and fully understands these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, and teaches them extensively to others as well, will remember their lives for twenty-one lifetimes. In this very life too, except for the effects of previous karma, they will be delivered from all harm caused by others, and they will be in harmony with all beings. If protection is performed for anyone with them, then none of the elemental spirits will be able to harm that person. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, and all humans and non-humans will be unable to harm them. Snakes, worms, intestinal worms, and all stinging and biting insects will be unable to harm them. Epidemics, disorders of wind, bile, and phlegm, their combination, and all that arises from the change of seasons will be unable to harm them. Fevers

of one day, two days, three days, four days, or seven days, fevers lasting half a month, a month, or a year, chronic illnesses, and sudden afflictions will be unable to harm them. Smallpox, swellings, boils, skin eruptions, skin diseases, rabid dogs, abscesses, all leprosy, all epidemic sicknesses, all murderous rites, all rites of transformation, all spells, and all corpse-raising spirits will also be unable to harm them.

"Ānanda, these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra were spoken by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas. Whoever is delivered by these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra is gathered into the company of all of them.

"Ānanda, one should keep these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra in mind even when staying in a king's palace. Keep them in mind even when among bandits. Keep them in mind even when among flesh-eating demons. Keep them in mind even when among fierce predators. Keep them in mind even in a lonely wilderness. Keep them in mind even when facing a river hard to cross. Keep them in mind even in the midst of fire. Keep them in mind even in the midst of water. For one who keeps them in mind, none of those dangers will arise. Even poison that person has eaten will turn into mere food.

"Ānanda, one who holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra cannot be harmed by any elemental spirits. Nor can they be harmed by any hungry ghosts, any malignant spirits, any murderous rites, any rites of transformation, and..."

all harmful spells, and by humans and non-humans of every kind. In short, Ānanda, no harm from others can overcome that person. Ānanda, a rite intended to kill will itself be cut off by the stroke of punishment. A rite of punishment will be undone by beating; a rite of beating, by binding; a rite of binding, by threatening; and a rite of threatening will be released simply by being met with a steady gaze.

"Ānanda, that anyone who has been guarded, protected, held, or bound by these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, and for whom peace and well-being have been made, should come to any other fate is impossible. In the world with its gods, with its māras, with its Brahmās, among the multitudes of beings with their ascetics and brahmins, among gods, humans, and asuras, I have never seen such a thing. Why is this? Because these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra have been blessed so that they bring about certain deliverance from all harm, epidemic, and turmoil."

Then, when this exposition of the Dharma was complete, the Four Great Kings spoke to the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, if we too may spread this exposition of the Dharma far and wide, take under our protection those who teach the Dharma, ensure that the true Dharma endures for a very long time, and subdue all the māras, we ask that these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra be granted to us. May the Blessed One be pleased to say 'Excellent.'" Then the Blessed One, out of compassion for the Four Great Kings, remained silent, and by this silence he gave his consent. The Four Great Kings, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, spoke these words by way of solemn utterance. They are as follows:

Daṇḍe, deṇaḍe, mahā-naḍe, jambhane, stambhane, ṭaṭe, ṭaṭane, mahā-ṭaṭane, kuṭṭe, kuṭṭane, mahā-kuṭṭane, dharmale, carmale, svāhā.

"Blessed One, these seem to be words belonging to the retinue of this dhāraṇī. Whatever son or daughter of good family holds these root formulas of the dhāraṇī mantra, or recites them aloud and carries them, will pass beyond all harm from others, except what comes from past karma, and will be in harmony with all beings. No obstacle will arise for that person even in upholding all the true Dharma."

Then the Blessed One gave the Four Great Kings his approval, saying: "Friends, it is excellent, excellent, that you have undertaken this so that my teaching may endure for a long time."

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, so that these formulas may become powerful in miracle, great in benefit, and great in blessing, take up this exposition of the Dharma of the dhāraṇī. Learn it, recite it, master it, retain it, understand it fully, and teach it extensively to others."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, I have taken it up so that it may be spread widely."

Then, in order to teach this very meaning at length, the Blessed One at that time spoke these verses.

This sūtra of dhāraṇī mantras
Was spoken by all the buddhas.
For the benefit of sentient beings,
I too have taught it.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī-mantra sūtra,
Or else reads it aloud,
For twenty-one lifetimes

Will remember their past lives.

Toward one who recites this dhāraṇī mantra,
No non-human being whatsoever,
No yakṣa, kumbhāṇḍa, or rākṣasa,
Will ever create an obstacle.

For one who recites this dhāraṇī mantra,
Whatever lords there are in the desire realm...

The wicked Māra
Will never create an obstacle.
The parents of one who holds this dhāraṇī-mantra,
Their brothers, their sisters,
Their friends and their kin,
Will never fall into wrong ways.

Therefore, when this dhāraṇī-mantra sūtra
Has been heard by one who is fearless,
Let that one who recites this dhāraṇī-mantra
Never be afraid, not even for a moment.

For one who holds this dhāraṇī-mantra,
Whatever obscuring karma
Was created over a thousand million eons
Will be purified in seven days.

Whatever merit the bodhisattvas
Have accumulated over a million eons,
The one who holds this dhāraṇī-mantra
Will surpass in seven days.

The four Great Kings,
Guardians of the world in the four directions,
Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa, Dhṛtarāṣṭra, and Vaiśravaṇa
(Evil Body, Ugly Eyes, Noble Born, Colorful and Renowned),
Together with their retinues and ministers,
Will always protect
The one who recites this dhāraṇī-mantra.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and those
great hearers, the noble Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, and the other bodhisattvas, the

great beings, the four Great Kings, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced, and praised what the Blessed One had said. This completes the noble dhāraṇī, The Supreme Lamp, King of Vidyā-mantras.

Translator's Notes

- The passage begins with a short colophon-like note, "having also corrected and settled it against the Chad version," which I have omitted as a scribal remark outside the sūtra proper.

The Tibetan "mi mjed" renders Sahā, the world of Śākyamuni, rendered here as "Endurance" in the traditional etymology.

The title's Sanskrit is given as in the text. The list of harmful beings includes some obscure terms: sbrang bu lcags phyé is rendered as "scorpion" on the likely reading of "iron-powder bee," which is uncertain. The last item, "near affliction," renders nye ba'i nyon mongs, which may here mean "any minor affliction."

The mantra is transliterated from the Tibetan-script Sanskrit and left unaltered.

- [illegible]

"सुप्रसन्नोऽपि सुप्रसन्नोऽपि सुप्रसन्नोऽपि" is syntactically odd, probably a corruption of the names. I gave the Sanskrit identifications as the most plausible reading rather than a literal translation of the line.

The final title is rendered as it stands, with "Supreme Lamp" for 最高の燈籠.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.